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Woman 6: Oh, I say!

Woman 5:
Isn't it a **scream**, dear? I sat on it the wrong way round, just for the laugh.

(Enter Nurse left, ferrying a large hammer. She crosses the stage and goes into the surgery.)

Man 6:
Was that a hammer she was carrying?

Man 7:
I've seen dentists use some **queer** tools.

Man 6:
Well, if it wasn't a hammer, I should be attending an eye specialist and not a dentist.

Woman 5:
I hope he isn't going to use it.

Man 3:
It's a peculiar thing to have in a surgery.

(The sound of hammering is heard from the surgery. Everyone looks at the surgery door and then at one another.)

Woman 1:
Oh! Joe! My poor Joe! Oh, what will I do?

(Standing.)

Woman 2:
I shouldn't worry. The dentist probably knows what he's doing.

Woman 1:
Yes, but does Joe? Surely he's not hammering on poor Joe's tooth.

Woman 2:
Now, sit down and don't excite yourself. I'm sure Joe is quite all right.

(Woman 1 sits. There is more hammering from the surgery. Woman 1 is about to stand but Woman 2 restrains her.)

Woman 2:
There, there, dear, do sit down quietly.

Man 5: I don't like the sound of that.

Man 4:
I shouldn't worry. These dentists know what they're doing. I hope.

(Nurse enters from the surgery and walks across the stage and out left. Everyone watches her in silence.)

Woman 7:
She didn't look very worried, anyway.

Woman 8: No, it's the patient who worries.

Woman 7:
I say let him worry. Worry is natural. It never did anyone any harm.

Woman 1:
I wish you wouldn't talk like that, with my poor Joe in there, may be **writhing** in **agony**.

(Enter Nurse left. She is carrying a large pair of pliers. She walks across the stage and into the surgery. Man 4 groans and everyone groans after him. Woman 1 watches in horror. She stands as the Nurse exits into the surgery.)

Woman 1: No, no, it can't be true! They can't do this to Joe. Not to my Joe.